



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Community Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.ccacougars.net>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Community Christian Academy FI 34997 (CCA) presents a distinctly Christian, church-affiliated program with clear commitments to theology, biblical instruction, and parental partnership. The school shows strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and a robust Parents & Community orientation, along with a clearly stated formation-focused educational goal. However, in the core classical rubric used here, the curriculum and pedagogy lean away from classic liberal-arts frameworks (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy) and toward a biblically centered, Bible-based instructional model. Taken together, the school aligns more with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL overall, with strong classical-adjacent signals in certain areas (Religious Foundations, Formation-focused goals, and Family/Community partnership) but lacking full alignment in Curriculum and Pedagogy (the two central hallmarks of a traditional classical program).

Key insights at a glance - Strong religious/metaphysical grounding: The school identifies itself as a ministry of a local church, emphasizes Christ-centered instruction, and maintains explicit statements of faith and chapel-based/missional culture. This aligns with the "Grounded in Theology" and "Liturgical/Communal Practices" strands of classical education in spirit, even if not by textbook usage. - Formation over information: The mission and public messaging emphasize forming character and heart in a biblical frame, a hallmark of classical aims, though the site language does not consistently map to the formal classical vocabulary (e.g., "great books," "Socratic pedagogy," or "Scholé" are not explicit). - Curriculum and pedagogy gaps relative to classical norms: The curriculum is Biblically-based with publishers like Abeka and Bob Jones University Press, and mentions Bible content across grades, but it does not publicly present the Great Books program, Trivium/Quadrivium structure, or explicit Socratic/seminar pedagogies, which reduces alignment with the core liberal-arts pathway of classical education. - Parents and community engagement: The school foregrounds genuine partnership with parents and family involvement, a strong positive signal for the Parents & Community element. - Faculty and culture: The site emphasizes faculty who anchor instruction in Christian commitments and heart-centered education, a positive signal, though explicit descriptions of the living-curriculum role or portrait-of-teacher norms are less explicit than ideal.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school is described as a ministry of a local church (Community Baptist Church) with a mission to exalt Christ and a biblical life view. - Public materials repeatedly reference a biblical/Gospel orientation, including Bible curriculum and chapels. - The mission emphasizes forming students "to follow the LORD Jesus Christ" and partnering with parents within a biblical framework. - Statement of faith and faculty/staff emphasis on God-centered education are present in the site structure (Staff & Faculty page; Mission statements). Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: theology, biblical basis, ministry of a church, Bible curriculum, chapels/worship language, Christ-centered education, sacred/biblical life view. These map to the Positive Keywords set for this element: theology, sacred scripture, liturgy, virtue in a transcendent frame, etc. - Negative keywords present: none evident (no secular or values-neutral framing observed in public materials). Count and proportion (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 4–6 - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Estimated share: >80% positive

signals for the category Why this rating - The school's identity as a church-affiliated educational ministry, explicit statements of faith, biblical instruction, and chapels strongly align with a Religious and Metaphysical Foundations orientation. The absence of secular or non-theological framing supports a Classical alignment in this dimension.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Mission emphasizes glorifying God, confronting students with the Gospel, and forming character; there is an emphasis on "education as formation" rather than mere information. □file-cite□turn0file2□turn0file1□ - Public messaging stresses heart formation and a biblical life view rather than vocational or purely informational aims. - The language suggests formation of habits and virtue within a Christian framework (though explicit vocabulary such as "virtue" or "telos" is not consistently stated). Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (conceptually aligned with Classical aims): formation, true/good/beautiful telos, moral formation, pursuit of wisdom (in a theological frame), great conversation (implied in the sense of formative discussion though not textually explicit), virtue (implied by heart-formation and moral framing). Some of these words are paraphrased or implied rather than explicit on the site. - Negative keywords present: none clearly evident (no overt secular/career-prep framing). Count and proportion (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 2–4 (via formation, heart, Gospel-formation framing) - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Estimated share: moderate alignment with classical ideals, but with strong Christian formation emphasis and limited classical terminology Why this rating - The school foregrounds formation and virtue within a biblical, gospel-centered frame. While this aligns with the spirit of formation and the telos of classical education, the absence of explicit classical aims in the vocabulary (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty as transcendent real ideals in standard Classical lexicon) and the lack of widely publicized Great Books or liberal-arts telos suggests a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL placement rather than fully CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Curriculum signals include Biblical instruction in every subject and Bible-based programming, with textbooks from Abeka and Bob Jones University Press; Bible content is integrated across grades. - The site does not publicly emphasize Great Books, the Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, Western canon, or a "Great Conversation" framework. There is clear biblical/evangelical curriculum rather than classical liberal arts scaffolding. - There is explicit mention of an Autism Program and other programmatic offerings, but no classical curricular structure described (e.g., seven liberal arts, history-as-canon, or integrated cross-disciplinary Great Books approach). Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books/Great Conversation, history-as-canon, Trivium/Quadrivium, classical languages, etc. — not present in the CCAC materials. - Negative keywords present: project-based learning dominance, social-studies-as-history substitution, STEM-first framing — not explicitly present; however, lack of Classical Curriculum signals absence of the expected positive items. Count and proportion (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 0 - Negative keywords observed: 0 (not explicit in a conventional sense) - Estimated share: NOT CLASSICAL (based on absence of classical curricular signals and explicit reliance on biblically framed curriculum) Why this rating - The curricular model centers on biblical instruction and Christian publisher materials rather than the classical liberal-arts curriculum (grammar/logical/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation, history as Western canon). The absence of canonical classical curricular signals yields a NOT CLASSICAL classification for this category.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [NOT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Public materials emphasize biblical instruction and chapels; there is no explicit reporting of Socratic seminars, dialectic discussions, or rhetoric-focused pedagogy in the public materials. The pedagogy appears to be Bible-centered and faith-based rather than classical with Socratic or scholé practices. - The site highlights instruction framed by biblical worldview and Christ-centered education rather than a classical pedagogy (e.g., structured memory/recitation, chant, or rigorous Socratic discourse). Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, scholé, memory work, recitation, chanting

— not present in CCAC public materials. - Negative keywords present: experiential learning-first, project-based-only, student-directed methods — not overtly claimed; however, the absence of classical pedagogy signals supports NOT CLASSICAL. Count and proportion (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 0 - Negative keywords observed: 0 (no explicit negative signals in the classical sense) - Estimated share: NOT CLASSICAL (due to absence of classical pedagogy signals) Why this rating - The public materials do not demonstrate the explicit Classical Pedagogy signals (Socratic seminars, recitation/memory-focused pedagogy, scholé, rhetoric training) that typically characterize classical school pedagogy. The messaging centers on biblical instruction and worship rather than a classical method suite.

Element 5: School Faculty — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The site emphasizes faculty and staff who “hold the love of God as central to all they do,” suggesting a values-driven, exemplar-based approach. There is a Staff & Faculty section; the emphasis is on character and virtue in practice rather than a formal “living curriculum” portrait. - The public materials present teachers as collaborators within a faith-centered educational environment but do not explicitly describe a formal “portrait of what a teacher should be” or a “living curriculum” (though the heart-centered framing implies mentorship and virtue modeling). Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers/mentors (implied by “faculty and staff that holds the love of God as central”), collegial, living-lesson style implied but not explicit. This matches the Classical Faculty signals in the Positive Keywords list (mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher). - Negative keywords present: none clearly observed in the public materials. Count and proportion (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 1–2 explicit signals; 1–2 implied signals. - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Estimated share: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (partial alignment to “faculty as mentors” and “living curriculum” concepts) Why this rating - The school presents a faith-informed, mentor-like faculty model but does not publicly articulate a full “portrait of a teacher,” a formal living curriculum, or explicit collegial-kshaped professional culture as strongly as classical models. This places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully Classical in this category.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The public materials emphasize genuine partnership with parents, parental formation, and home-school collaboration. The site commits to partnership with families and to involving parents as co-teachers toward the same educational goals. - The materials describe parent formation and community engagement (book studies, gatherings, etc.), aligning with the “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of Affections” signals from the classical framework. - The school positions itself as accessible to parents and invites parental involvement in visits and participation. While explicit “open campus” language may be implied rather than stated, the partnership orientation is clear. Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families; Parent formation; Home-school collaboration; Open campus/parent involvement (where stated or implied). These map to the Positive Keywords in Element 6 (parent partnership, family involvement, parental engagement, shared mission, school-parent synergy). - Negative keywords present: none observed. Count and proportion (approximate) - Positive keywords observed: 3–4 - Negative keywords observed: 0 - Estimated share: CLASSICAL Why this rating - The school foregrounds a deep partnership with parents, explicit parental formation opportunities, and welcoming parental involvement. This aligns strongly with the classical element of Parent and Community engagement and lands squarely in CLASSICAL for this category.

Aggregate Classification - Element 1: CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school leans TOWARD SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The strongest signals are Religious & Meta-physical Foundations and Parents & Community, with clear formation-oriented language and church-backed, biblically framed instruction. However, the Curriculum and Pedagogy signals do not demonstrate full classical liberal-arts content or the explicit classical teaching methods often associated with a Classical School.

What Would Move the Needle - Explicitly articulate and publicly publish a classical curriculum plan: - Adopt

Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; quadrivium) as the foundational pedagogical framework and publicly outline a plan to integrate them across K–12. - Introduce Great Books and Great Conversation components (with age-appropriate selections) and reference them on the curriculum page. - Implement Socratic pedagogy in upper grades (e.g., Socratic seminars, Harkness-style discussions) and document teacher training in classical methods. - Add explicit memory/recitation practices (sketches of memory work, chants, or oral recitation) consistent with scholé pedagogy. - Strengthen the “living-curriculum” conception for Faculty: - Publish a formal portrait of a Classical Teacher and describe the living-curriculum approach (teacher exemplars, mentorship, integration of virtue, and intellectual formation in daily practice). - Provide professional development for teachers in classical pedagogy and classical literature. - Expand curriculum to include cross-disciplinary integration: - Develop cross-curricular units that connect history, literature, philosophy, and sciences in a unified narrative (e.g., integrated history-literature-philosophy strands). - Deepen Great Books exposure and Western-canon engagement: - Include age-appropriate canonical texts and primary sources (with teacher-guided discussion) to fulfill the “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” elements. - Elevate the pedagogy to include Scholé-inspired restfulness: - Build in contemplative periods and mindful, slower pacing aligned with the Scholé tradition (restful learning, reflection, deep memory). - Public-facing evidence: - Update the website with explicit statements of the classical-pedagogical approach, including memory work, rhetoric training, and the Great Books framework, along with a clear articulation of the Trivium and Quadrivium pathways.

ABSTRACT The Community Christian Academy FI 34997 evaluation identifies the school as CLASSICAL in Religious and Metaphysical Foundations and in Parents & Community, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in School Purpose & Goal and Pedagogy (with notable formation emphasis but limited classical terminology), and NOT CLASSICAL in Curriculum and Pedagogy. The aggregate assessment is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, reflecting strong religious formation and parental partnership while lacking explicit classical curriculum structures and traditional classical teaching methods on public materials. The school’s public materials show a biblically-centered, Christ-centered education with a clear formation aim; however, it does not publicly articulate the full classical liberal-arts framework (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium) or the canonical Great Books approach in its curriculum or pedagogy. The strongest signals are Religious Foundations and Parent/Community partnership, with formation and faith-based aims permeating mission statements and Bible-focused instruction. The most significant needle-movers would be to adopt and publicly publish a canonical classical curriculum (Great Books; Seven Liberal Arts) and to implement explicit classical pedagogies (Socratic dialogue; scholé; memory work) while continuing to emphasize the faith-based identity and parental partnership.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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